

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Sesame-Crusted Tilapia

with Blistered Peppers, Rice, and Tahini-Ginger Dressing

The toasted sesame seed paste known as tahini isn't just for Mediterranean and Middle Eastern dishes. Clearly, sesame is a predominant flavor in the Asian pantry. So, tahini adds a flavor boost and some serious creaminess to tonight's soy sauce–based dressing, complete with scallions and super-fragrant ginger.

25–35 minutes 610 calories per serving

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MEALS WORTH MAKING

Ingredients

- ½ cup jasmine rice
- 3 mini sweet peppers
- 1 scallion
- ⅛ ounce ginger
- 2 packets gluten-free soy sauce
- 1 tablespoon tahini
- 10 ounces tilapia
- 2 teaspoons sesame seeds
- 2 teaspoons shichimi togarashi
- 4 ounces shishito peppers
- 1 tablespoon sesame oil

You'll need

canola oil
kosher salt
6" small pot with lid
aluminum foil
baking sheet
12" large pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Salt helps break down the ginger, extracting its natural juices to create a smooth, flavorful paste.

Japanese *schichimi togarashi* blends seven (*shichi*) spices—black and white sesame seeds, ground chiles, ginger, seaweed, and orange peel are most common. It's a bit spicy, so feel free to use less.

Your tilapia is finished cooking when it flakes easily with a fork or a thin knife inserted into the fish meets no resistance. USDA recommends cooking fish to 145°F.

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1927-7423-2P



1. Cook rice

Preheat oven to 450°F. In a small pot, combine **rice**, **¾ cup water**, and **¼ teaspoon salt**, and bring to a boil over high heat. Stir once, reduce heat to medium low, cover pot, and simmer until water is fully absorbed, 10–12 minutes. Remove pot from heat and let stand, still covered, for 10 minutes. Fluff **rice** with a fork, then cover again to keep warm until ready to serve.



2. Prepare ingredients

While rice cooks, rinse all produce. Quarter **mini peppers** lengthwise, discarding seeds and stems. Trim and discard **scallion** root; mince **whites and light greens** and thinly slice **dark greens**, keeping separate.



3. Make tahini-ginger dressing

Trim and discard skin of **ginger** and mince; then, still on cutting board, sprinkle over **⅛ teaspoon salt**. Using a large knife, carefully scrape over mixture at a 45° angle, pressing down. Repeat until ginger is broken down and a paste forms (see recipe tip). In a medium bowl, whisk together **soy sauce**, **tahini**, **ginger paste**, **scallion whites and light greens**, **2 tablespoons canola oil**, and **2 teaspoons water** until smooth. Set aside.



4. Roast tilapia

Line a baking sheet with foil. Pat **tilapia** dry with paper towel and place on prepared sheet. Rub all over with **1 teaspoon canola oil** and **¼ teaspoon salt**. Gently press **sesame seeds** and **schichimi togarashi** onto tops of fish (see recipe tip). Roast until sesame seeds are golden and tilapia is opaque and cooked through, 7–9 minutes (see recipe tip).



5. Sauté peppers

While tilapia roasts, pat **shishito peppers** very dry with paper towel to prevent steaming in the pan. Heat **sesame oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **mini peppers** and **shishito peppers** and sauté, stirring occasionally, until blistered and slightly tender, 6–7 minutes. Season with **⅛ teaspoon salt**, then remove pan from heat and set aside.



6. Plate sesame-crusted tilapia

To pot with rice, still off heat, stir in **half of scallion dark greens** to combine. Divide **scallion rice** between serving bowls, then top with **sesame-crusted tilapia** and **blistered peppers**. Drizzle with **tahini-ginger dressing** and garnish with **remaining scallion dark greens**. Enjoy!

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